

Polar Star Crochet Sweater / Poncho Pattern

by Natalia Kononova at www.OutstandingCrochet.com

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Skill Level:

- Intermediate.
- Instructions are given in English language, American crochet terminology.

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Sizes:

- One size fits most S – 2X / 86.5 – 127 cm / 34 – 50" bust circumference.
- Sweater is shown on a model size M / 37 3/8" / 95 cm bust circumference.

Materials and Tools:

- Heavy Worsted / Aran / #4 weight yarn. Shown here Caron One Pound (100% acrylic, 453.6 g / 16 oz / 742 m / 812 yards), 670 g / 23.7 oz / 1200 yards in Soft Grey Mix (color A) and 230 g / 8.2 oz / 412 yards in White (color B).
- Recommended yarn is Heavy Worsted weight: 179 yds / 163.6 m / 100 g. If you'd like to use thinner yarn, please, refer to Morning Star Poncho Sweater Crochet Pattern instructions.
- 5 mm / H-8 crochet hook.
- Tapestry needle, pins.

Gauge / tension:

- [Square Motif](#) side is 18 cm (7").
- [Half Double crochet Rib Stitch](#): 10 cm x 10 cm / 4" x 4" = 8 rows x 13 sts made with Heavy Worsted weight yarn and 5 mm / H-8 hook.

Note:

Differences between Polar Star and Morning Star Poncho Sweater Patterns:

- Morning Star Sweater was designed for Light Worsted weight yarn (compare to Heavy Worsted weight yarn for the Polar Star Sweater).
- Morning Star Sweater instructions include sizes S/M and L/XL/2X (compare to one size fits most S – 2X for the Polar Star Sweater pattern).
- Bottom band, cuffs and cowl collar are made and joined as you go to the Morning Star Sweater, but made separately and sewed to the Polar Star Sweater.
- Square Motif is slightly different for the two patterns.
- Motifs are joined as you go in both patterns, but every other stitch is joined to the back loop of a stitch from adjoining motif in the Polar Star Sweater Pattern, instead of every stitch in both loops in the Morning Star Sweater Pattern. Polar Star instructions also include a video on joining motifs as you go.

Abbreviations:

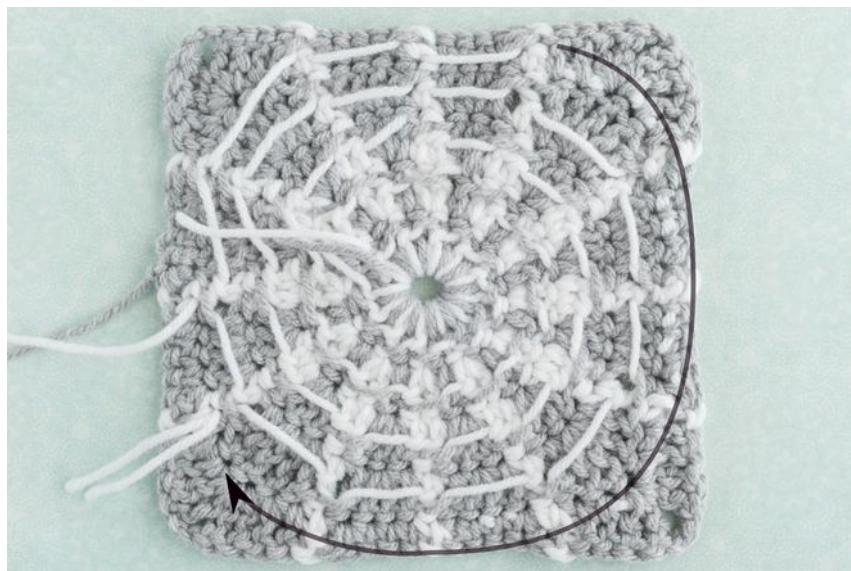
"	inches	FPsc	front post sc	rep	repeat
()	rep inst bet ()'s as many times as noted afterward	g	gram(s)	Rev st st	reverse stockinette st
*	rep inst for single * as directed	hdc	half double crochet	RH	right hand
**	rep inst bet **'s as many times as noted after	inc	increase	rnd(s)	round(s)
[], { }	rep inst bet []'s or { }'s as many times as noted after	K, k	knit	RS	right side
approx	approximately	K1-b	knit 1 st tbl	sc	single crochet
beg	begin/beginning	k2tog	knit 2 sts together	sk	skip
bet	between	KFB	knit into the front and back of stitch	sk2p	sl 1, k2tog, psso
BO	bind off	kwise	knitwise	sl	slip
BLsc	back loop sc	LH	left hand	sl st	slip stitch
Bpsc	back post sc	M1	make 1 stitch	sm	slip marker
CC	contrast color	M1L	make a left-leaning stitch	ssk	sl, sl, k these 2 sts tog
ch	chain stitch	M1R	make a right-leaning stitch	sssk	sl, sl, sl, k these 3 sts tog
ch-# sp	ch-# space	MC	main color	St st	stockinette st
cm	centimeter(s)	lp(s)	loop(s)	sp(s)	space(s)
cn	cable needle	m	marker	st(s)	stitch(es)
CO	cast on	mm	millimeter(s)	tbl	through back loop
Con	Connecting	oz	ounce	tfl	through front loop
cont	continue	p	picot	tog	together
dc	double crochet	PU	pick up	tr	treble crochet
dec	decrease	P, p	purl	ttr	triple treble
DPN(s)	double pointed needle(s)	p2tog	purl 2 sts together	w&t	wrap & turn (see specific inst in pat)
dtr	double treble	pat	pattern	WE	work even
EOR	every other row	pm	place marker	WS	wrong side
FLsc	front loop sc	pr	previous row	wyib	with yarn in back
		prev	previous	wyif	with yarn in front
		Psso	Pass slipped st over	yd(s)	yard(s)
		pwise	purlwise	yo	yarn over
		R	row		
		rem	remain(ing)		

US = UK crochet terminology:

sc = double crochet (dc), hdc = half treble (htr), dc = treble (tr), tr = double treble (dtr), dtr = triple treble (trtr), sk (skip) = miss, gauge = tension, yo = yarn over hook (yoh).

Special stitches, abbreviations, notes:

- **Colors abbreviations:** **A** – Soft Grey Mix, **B** – White.
- **/swA, /swB:** when any stitch includes /swA or /swB it means that next st will be made with another color. Switch to another color while finishing the stitch: make last yo with next color and draw yarn through rem lps on hook.
- **Working with 2 colors:** Pick up yarn from the back. Grab one color always from top and another color from below to avoid tangling. When picking up next color, leave a strand on WS making sure it's not too tight or too loose. Alternatively, you can handle yarn which is not currently used as in the tapestry crochet: align working end of currently not used yarn with the prev row (behind the row) and work sts in prev row and over other yarn at the same time. Be aware that other yarn can become visible bet sts on RS, especially if using thinner yarn.

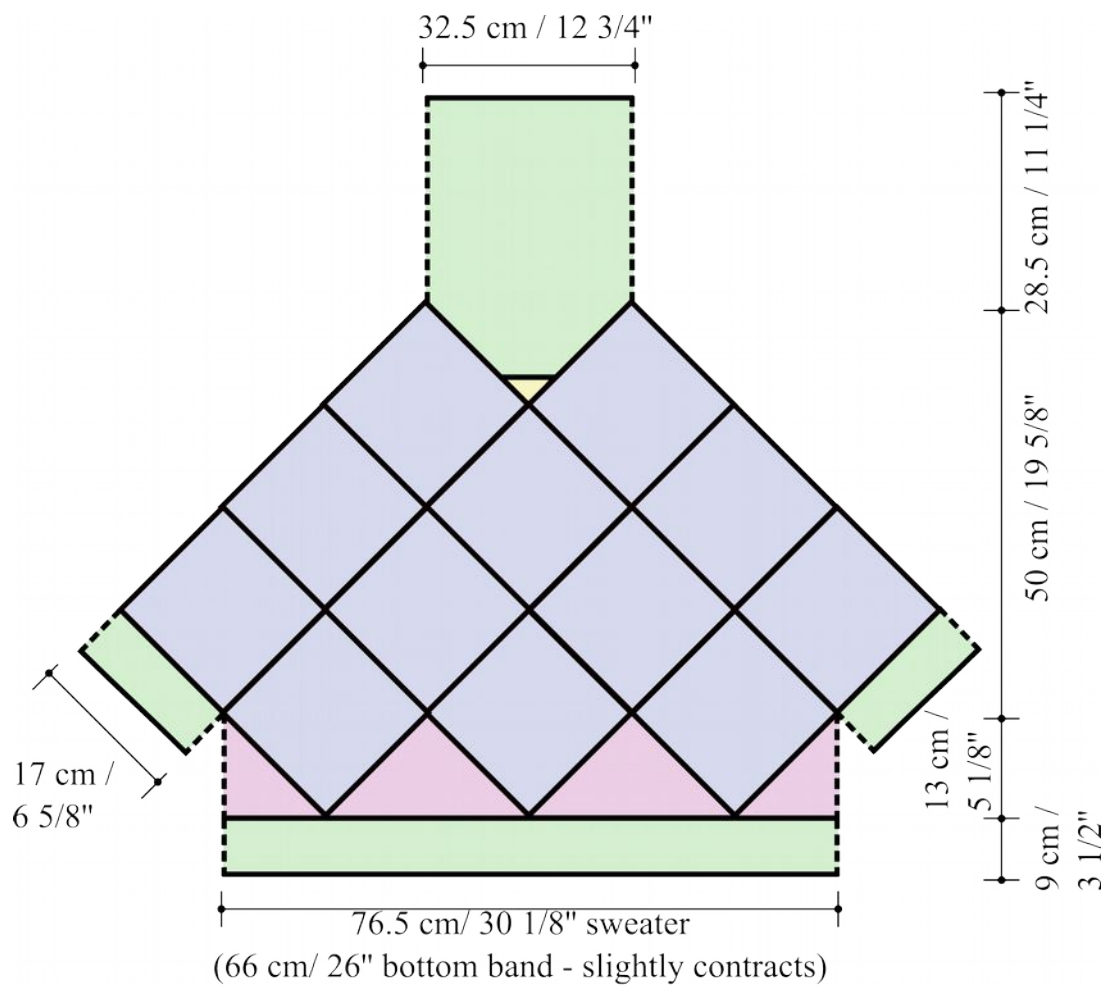


Switching bet color was done by leaving a strand on WS. Compare with a part of the last round when other yarn was aligned with the prev row and sts were made over it. I found that hiding other yarn resulted in the last round become stretchy and ruffled. The prototype was made with leaving strands on WS.

- **Dc2inc, tr2inc, tr3inc:** increase, 2 or 3 double crochet or treble crochet in same stitch.
- **Dc2tog (dc3tog):** decrease, 2 (3) double crochet together.
- **Join bet motifs:** [make st that will be joined to adjacent st from another motif, take loop off hook, insert hook from RS in adjacent st / back loop of adjacent stitch from another motif, pick up lp, draw it through st]. To make next join rep bet []'s.

[Watch video tutorial for joining motifs](#)

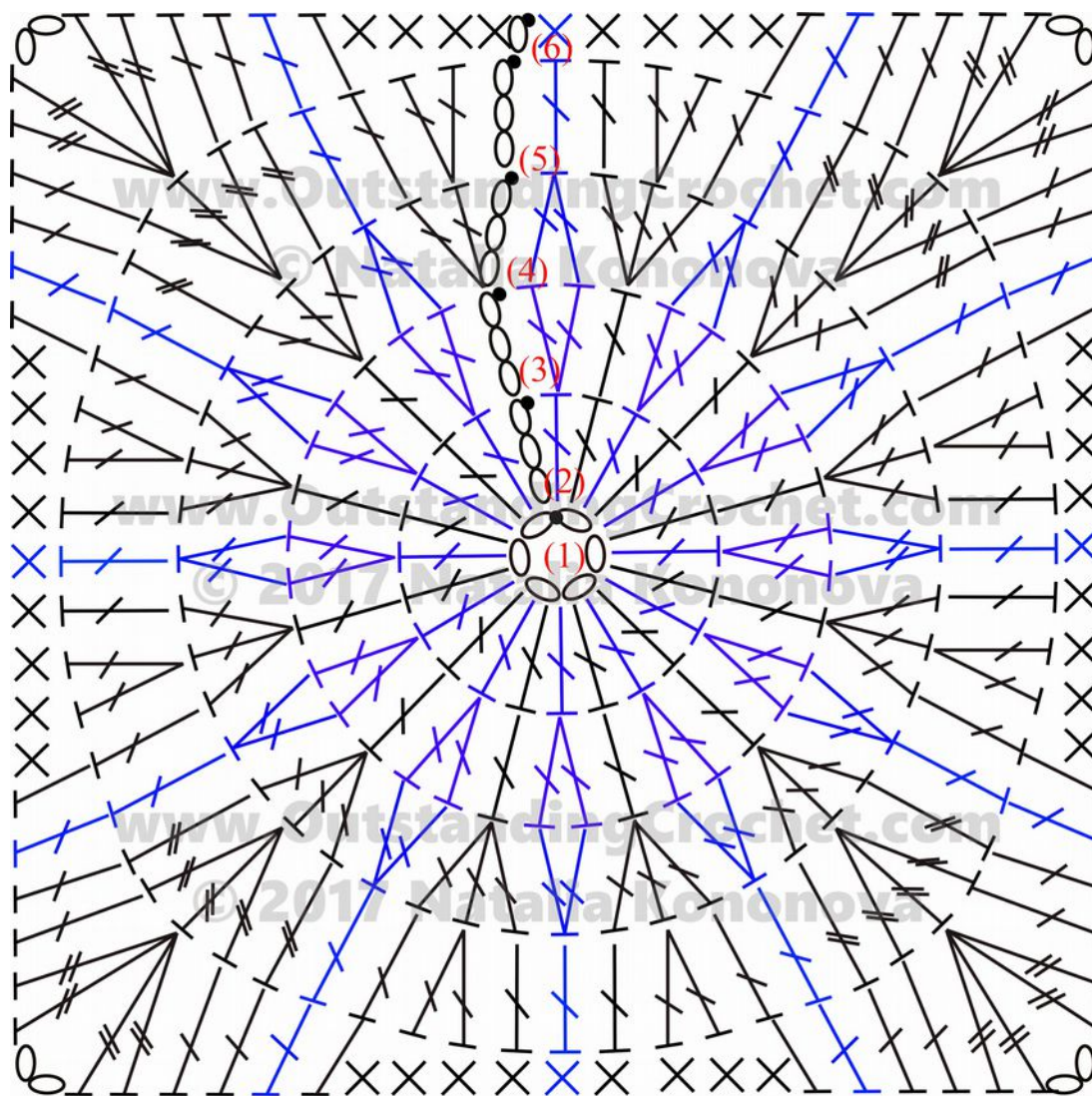
- **Fasten off:** fasten off, leaving 4" (10 cm) end.
- **Weave in:** thread tapestry needle with 10 cm (4") end, insert needle on WS under preferably the same color strands, draw yarn for about 2 cm ($\frac{3}{4}$ "), 2 - 3 times back and forth. Cut off end.



Order of work:

- 24 square motifs
- 6 triangular motifs
- neck opening edging
- bottom band, arm opening bands, cowl collar

Square motif 1:



Stitch Key:

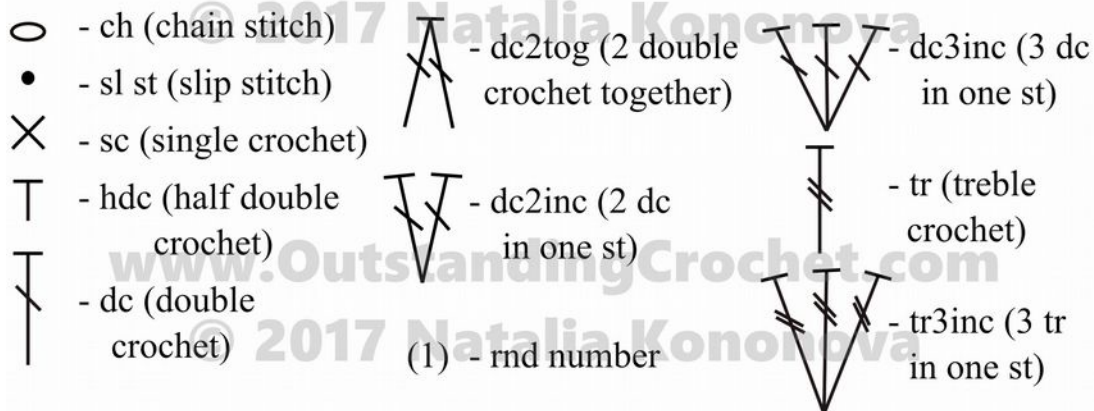


Chart 1. Square motif. Black symbols – color A, blue symbols – color B.

Note: Caron One Pound Yarn is Heavy Worsted weight yarn. If your yarn is thinner consider following Morning Star Sweater Pattern.

[Step by step pictures](#)

Chart 1

Rnd 1: with A ch 6, sl st in 1st ch to join.

Rnd 2: with A ch 3 (counts as dc), join B: yo B, draw yarn through last ch. Make a loop out of A-tail and align it with ch-6 ring, work rnd in ch-6 ring and A-tail ring at the same time to avoid weaving in. [With B dc/swA, with A dc/swB] 11 times, with B dc/swA, sl st in 3rd ch of beg ch-3 – 24 sts. Cut off A-tail as it was already weaved in by aligning with ch-6 ring.

Rnd 3: with A ch 3 (counts as dc), switch to B: yo B, draw yarn through last ch. [(With B dc2inc/swA) in next dc*, with A dc/swB in next dc] 11 times, rep from [to *, sl st in 3rd ch of beg ch-3.

Rnd 4: with A ch 3 (counts as dc), dc in same 3rd ch, dc/swB in same 3rd ch, [with B dc2tog/swA*, (with A dc3inc/swB) in next dc] 11 times, rep from [to *, sl st in 3rd ch of beg ch-3.

Rnd 5: [with A ch 3 (counts as dc), dc2inc (2 dc in one st) in next st, dc/swB, with B dc/swA, with A tr, tr3inc (3 tr in one st), tr/swB, with B dc/swA] 4 times, except on 2nd, 3rd and 4th reps make dc instead of ch-3 in the beg, sl st in 3rd ch of beg ch-3.

Rnd 6: with A ch 1, [sc in same 3rd ch, sc in next 2 sts, (sc, hdc/swB) in next st, with B dc/swA, with A dc in next 2 sts, (2 tr, ch 2 - corner, 2 tr) in next st, dc, dc/swB, with B dc/swA, with A (hdc, sc) in next st, sc in next 2 sts, sc/swB, with B sc/swA] 4 times, except on 2nd, 3rd and 4th reps make (sc in next st) instead of (sc in same 3rd ch) in the beg, sl st in 1st sc. Fasten off.

Square motifs 2 - 24:

Connect to previous motif(s) as you go in Rnd 6.

[Schematic for joining motifs](#)

Rep Rnds 1 – 5.

[Connecting by 1 side:](#)

Note: join after every 2nd st to adjoining st from another motif (in both loops or in back loop only). Photo – tutorial shows first way, video-tutorial shows latter. When you join in back loops only joining “seam” looks flatter.

[Video tutorial for joining motifs](#)

[Step by step pictures](#)

Rnd 6 (connecting to one motif): rep Rnd 6 to corner ch-2 bet 3rd and 4th sides. *Ch 1, (join: take lp off hook, insert hook in ch-2 sp of another motif from RS, pick up lp, draw it

through ch-2 sp), ch 1, 2 tr in same st, (join: take lp off hook, sk 1 tr after ch-2 sp from another motif, insert hook in next tr (or in back loop only as it's shown in video-tutorial), pick up lp, draw it through st), follow this pattern: make 2 sts from Rnd 6, sk 1 st of another motif, make join in next. Last join for this side is after 1st ch of corner ch-2 sp bet 4th and 1st sides in adjacent motif ch-2 sp. Finish motif. Fasten off.

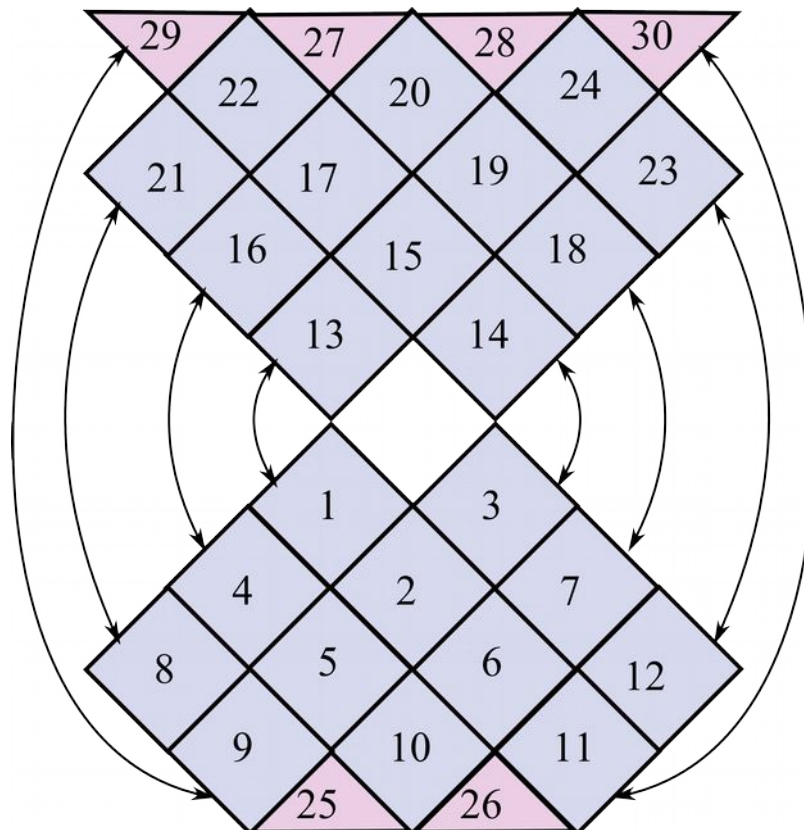
Connecting by 2 sides:

Rnd 6 (connecting to two motifs): rep Rnd 6 to ch-2 bet 2nd and 3rd sides. Rep “connecting to one motif” instructions to ch-2 bet 3rd and 4th sides.

Connecting corner to 2 other corners (double join): ch 1, (double join: take lp off hook, insert hook in ch-2 sp of the same motif you connected 3rd side to, pick up lp, draw in through ch-2 sp, take lp off hook again, insert hook from RS in ch-2 sp from the motif adjacent to 4th side, pick up lp and draw it through ch-2 sp), connect 4th side as in prev instructions. Finish motif. Fasten off.

Connecting by 3 sides:

Rnd 6 (connecting to three motifs): rep Rnd 6 to ch-2 bet 1st and 2nd sides. Rep instructions, joining 2nd, 3rd and 4th sides. Finish motif. Fasten off.



Schematic for connecting motifs as you go.

Square motif step-by-step:



Rnd 1: with A ch 6, sl st in 1st ch to join.

Rnd 2: with A ch 3 (counts as dc), join B: yo B, draw yarn through last ch. Make a loop out of A-tail and align it with ch-6 ring,



work rnd in ch-6 ring and A-tail ring at the same time to avoid weaving in. [With B dc/swA,



with A dc/swB] 11 times,



with B dc/swA, sl st in 3rd ch of beg ch-3
– 24 sts.



WS. Cut off beg A-tail.



Rnd 3: with A ch 3(counts as dc), switch to B: yo B, draw yarn through last ch.



[(With B dc2inc/swA) in next dc*,



with A dc/swB in next dc] 11 times,



rep from [to *,



sl st in 3rd ch of beg ch-3.



Rnd 4: with A ch 3 (counts as dc), dc in same 3rd ch, dc/swB in same 3rd ch,



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[with B dc2tog/swA in next 2 dc*,



(with A 2 dc, dc/swB) in next dc] 11 times,



rep from [to *, sl st in 3rd ch of beg ch-3.



Rnd 5: [with A ch 3 (counts as dc),
dc2inc (2 dc in one st) in next st, dc/swB,



with B dc/swA,



with A tr, tr3inc (3 tr in one st), tr/swB,



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with B dc/swA,



with A dc, dc2inc, dc/swB,



with B dc/swA] 4 times,



except on 2nd, 3rd and 4th reps make dc instead of ch-3 in the beg, sl st in 3rd ch of beg ch-3.



Rnd 6: with A ch 1, [sc in same 3rd ch, sc in next 2 sts, (sc, hdc/swB) in next st,



with B dc/swA,



with A dc in next 2 sts, (2 tr, ch 2 - corner, 2 tr) in next st, dc, dc/swB,



with B dc/swA, next picture: (with A hdc, sc) in next st, sc in next 2



sts, sc/swB, with B sc/swA] 4 times,



except on 2nd, 3rd and 4th reps make (sc in next st) instead of (sc in same 3rd ch) in the beg, sl st in 1st sc.

Connecting motifs as you go step-by-step:



Make ch 1 (1st of corner ch-2), (**join:** take lp off the hook, insert hook from RS in ch-2 sp, pick up lp and draw it through ch-2 sp).



Ch 1, 2 tr in same st, sk 1 st from adjacent motif (1st tr after ch-2), rep join in next st / back loop of next st (2nd tr after ch-2).



Keep making 2 sts, skipping 1, joining in next until you make 1st ch of next corner ch-2.



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After ch 1 make join in corner ch-2 sp.



Finish motif.



When connecting 3rd motif make join in ch-2 sp from adjacent motif only.



When connecting 4th motif, make double join: ch 1 (1st of corner ch-2), join in adjacent motif ch-2 sp,



take lp off hook, make join in another motif ch-2 sp (adjacent to next side, sk motif bet them),



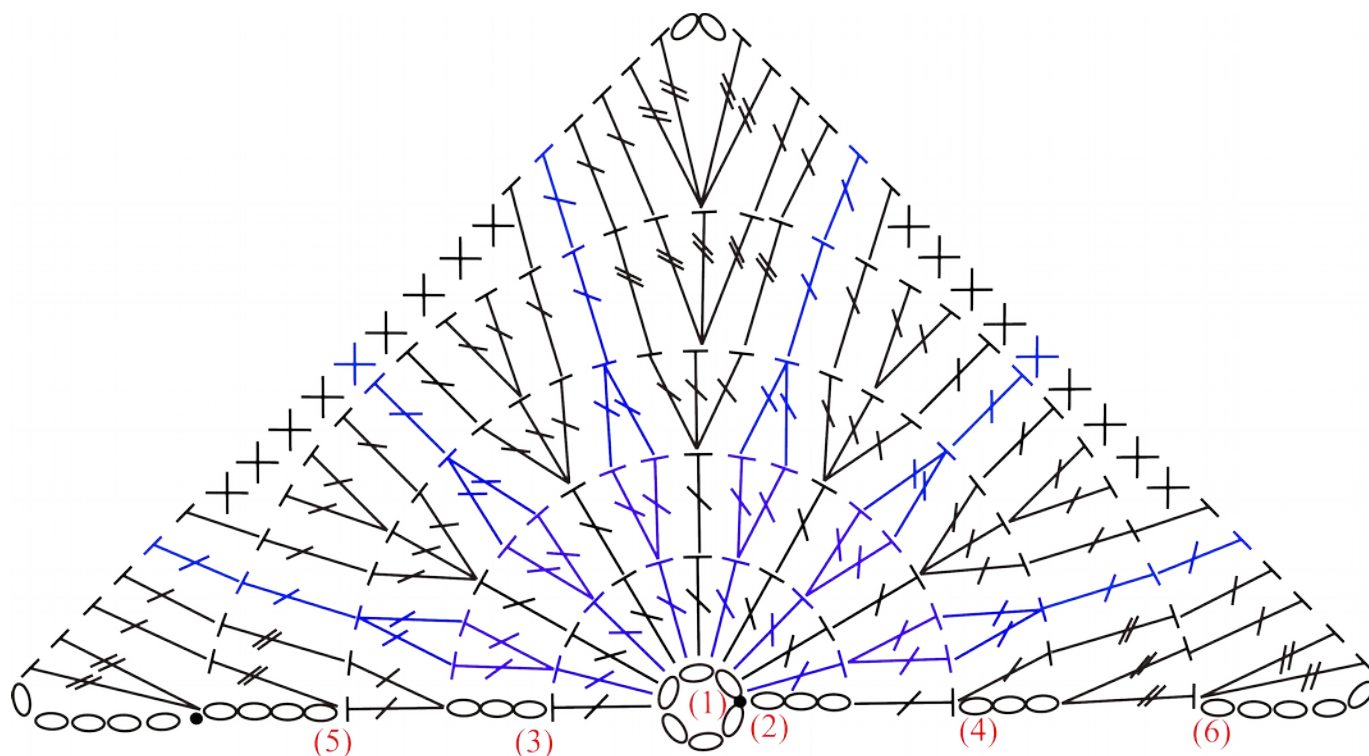
connect next side, finish motif.



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Triangular (half-motifs) 25 – 30:



Stitch Key:

○ - ch (chain stitch)	⋈ - dc2tog (2 double crochet together)	⋈ - tr (treble crochet)
• - sl st (slip stitch)		
× - sc (single crochet)		
⋈ - hdc (half double crochet)	⋈ - dc2inc (2 dc in one st)	⋈ - tr3inc (3 tr in one st)
⋈ - dc (double crochet)	(1) - rnd number	

Chart 3. Triangular (half) motif.
Black symbols – color A, blue symbols – color B.

Step by step pictures

Rnd 1: with A ch 6, sl st in 1st ch to join.

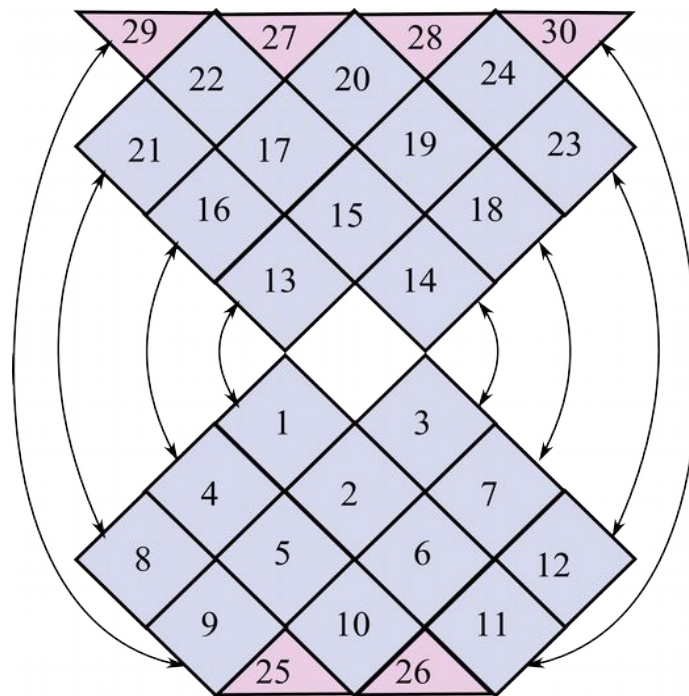
Row 2 (RS): with A ch 3 (counts as dc), join B: yo B, draw yarn through last ch. Make a loop out of A tail and align it with ch-6 ring, work row in ch-6 ring and A-tail ring at the same time to avoid weaving in. [With B dc/swA, with A dc/swB] 5 times, with B dc/swA, with A dc – 13 sts. Cut off beg A-tail, since it was already weaved in by aligning with ch-6 ring.

Row 3 (WS): turn, keep both yarn working ends on WS you're facing for this row. With A ch 3 (counts as dc), switch to B: yo B, draw yarn through last ch. [(With B dc, dc/swA) in next dc, with A dc/swB in next dc] 5 times, (with B dc, dc/swA) in next dc, with A dc in 3rd ch of prev row beg ch-3.

Row 4 (RS): turn, keep both yarns on WS. With A ch 3 (counts as dc), dc/swB in same st, [with B dc2tog/swA in next 2 dc, (with A 2 dc, dc/swB) in next dc] 5 times, with B dc2tog/swA in next 2 dc, with A dc2inc in 3rd ch of prev row beg ch-3.

Row 5 (WS): turn, keep both yarn working ends on WS you're facing. With A ch 4 (counts as tr), tr in same st, tr/swB, *with B dc/swA, with A dc, dc2inc, dc/swB, with B dc/swA, with A dc, dc2inc, dc/swB, with B dc/swA, with A tr*, tr3inc, tr/swB, rep bet *'s, with A tr2inc in 3rd ch of prev row beg ch-3.

Row 6 (RS, connecting to 2 square motifs): turn, with A ch 4 (counts as tr), (join: take lp off hook, insert hook from RS in adjacent motif corner ch-2 sp, pick up lp, draw it through ch-2 sp), *ch 1, 2 tr in same st, sk 1 tr after ch-2 sp from adjacent motif, join in next tr, with A dc, dc/swB, sk 1 st, join in next, with B dc/swA, with A hdc, sk 1 st, join in next, with A sc in same st, sc in next st, sk 1 st, join, with A sc, sc/swB, sk 1 st, join, with B sc/swA, with A sc, sk 1 st, join, with A 2 sc, sk 1 st, join, (with A sc, hdc/swB) in next st, sk 1 st, join, with B dc/swA, with A dc, sk 1 st, join, with A dc*, tr, sk 1 st, join, with A tr in same st, ch 1, (double join: draw lp through corner ch-2 sp, sk motif bet 2 motifs, take lp off hook again, draw it through corner ch-2 sp of motif adjacent to next side), rep bet *'s, with A tr in 4th ch of beg ch-4 from prev row, sk 1 st, join, with A tr in same st, ch 1, join in ch-2 sp, ch 4, sl st in same 4th ch. Fasten off.



Triangular (half-motifs) step-by-step:



Rnd 1: with A ch 6, sl st in 1st ch to join.

Row 2 (RS): with A ch 3 (counts as 1st dc), join B: yo B, draw yarn through last ch. Make lp out of A tail and align it with ch-6 ring, work row in ch-6 ring and A-tail ring at the same time to avoid weaving in. [With B dc/swA, with A dc/swB] 5 times, with B dc/swA, with A dc – 13 sts. Cut off beg A-tail, since it was already weaved in by aligning with ch-6 ring.



Row 3 (WS): turn, keep both yarn working ends on WS you're facing for this row. With A ch 3 (counts as dc),



switch to B: yo B, draw yarn through last ch. [(With B dc, dc/swA) in next dc,



with A dc/swB in next dc] 5 times,



(with B dc, dc/swA) in next dc, with A dc in 3rd ch of prev row beg ch-3.



Row 4 (RS): turn, keep both yarns on WS. With A ch 3 (counts as dc), dc/swB in same st,



[with B dc2tog/swA in next 2 dc, (with A 2 dc, dc/swB) in next dc] 5 times, with B dc2tog/swA in next 2 dc, with A 2 dc in 3rd ch of prev row beg ch-3.



Row 5 (WS): turn, keep both yarn working ends on WS you're facing. With A ch 4 (counts as tr), tr in same st, tr/swB,



*with B dc/swA,



with A dc, dc2inc, dc/swB,



with B dc/swA, with A dc, dc2inc, dc/swB, with B dc/swA, with A tr*, tr3inc, tr/swB, rep bet *'s,



with A tr2inc in 3rd ch of prev row beg ch-3.



Row 6 (RS, connecting to 2 square motifs): turn, with A ch 4 (counts as tr), (join: take lp off hook, insert hook from RS in adjacent motif corner ch-2 sp, pick up lp,



draw it through ch-2 sp), *ch 1, 2 tr in same st,



sk 1 tr after ch-2 sp from adjacent motif, join in next tr / back loop of next tr,



with A dc, dc/swB, sk 1 st, join in next,



with B dc/sw A, with A hdc, sk 1 st, join in next,



with A sc in same st, sc in next st, sk 1 st, join, with A sc, sc/swB, sk 1 st, join, with B sc/swA, with A sc, sk 1 st, join, with A 2 sc, sk 1 st, join, (with A sc, hdc/swB) in next st, sk 1 st, join,



with B dc/swA, with A dc, sk 1 st, join, with A dc*, tr, sk 1 st, join, with A tr in same st, ch 1, (double join: draw lp through corner ch-2 sp,



sk motif bet 2 motifs, take lp off hook again, draw it through corner ch-2 sp of motif adjacent to next side),



rep bet *'s, with A tr in 4th ch of beg ch-4 from prev row, sk 1 st, join, with A tr in same st, ch 1, join in ch-2 sp, ch 4, sl st in same 4th ch. Fasten off.

Neck opening edging (make 2):

To smooth “V” neck line bet motifs join A with sl st in 4th st (A-dc after B-dc) from corner ch-2 sp of RH motif. Sc in next st, hdc, dc, tr in ch-2 sp of RH motif, tr in ch-2 sp of next motif (between RH and LH motifs), tr in ch-2 sp of LH motif, dc, hdc, sc in next st, sl st in next st. Fasten off.

Rep same instructions for the other side.



Cowl collar:

Half double crochet rib stitch step-by-step pictures

Foundation: loosely ch 37.

Row 1: ch 1, hdc in back ridges (small “humps” at the back of ch sts) of 37 ch, turn.

Row 2 – 52: ch 1, hdc in front lps of 36 hdc from prev row, hdc in back ridge of turning ch-1 from prev row (follow step-by-step pictures), turn counter-clockwise.

Fasten off, leaving 70 cm / 27 ½" end.

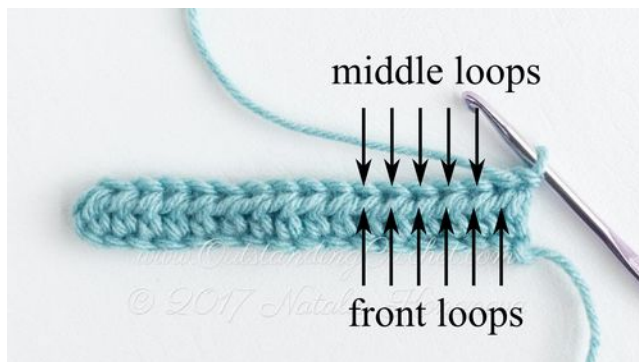
Half Double Crochet Rib Stitch step-by-step:



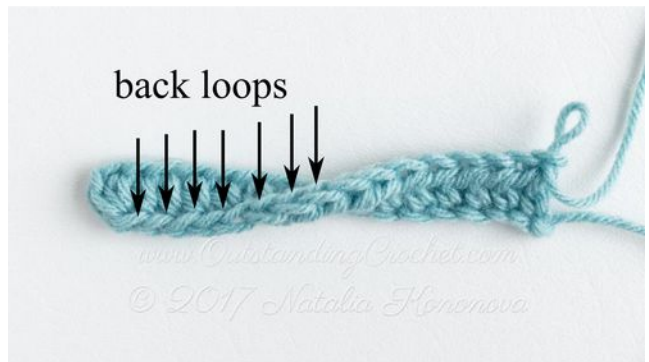
Row 1: ch directed number of sts, turning ch 1, hdc in back ridge (small “hump” at the back of ch) of 2nd ch from hook, hdc in back ridges of rem ch sts.



Row 1.



Row 2: ch 1, turn counter-clockwise. Locate front loops, middle loops and back loops of hdc sts from prev row.



Work Row 2 in front loops only.



1st FLhdc.



1st FLhdc.



FLhdc before last.



Last hdc in back ridge of turning ch-1 from prev row (loop 2), turn. **Note:** making last hdc in back ridge of turning ch-1 creates neat edging. If you are not sure, turn to other side. Locate turning ch-1, locate its back ridge.



Row 2.



Row 3: - last: rep Row 2.



Row 3.

Thread tapestry needle with the end and sew last and 1st rows tog with Mattress stitch for about 10 cm, then turn collar inside out and finish seam facing other side because collar will be folded outwards (see pictures).

Pin collar to the edge of neck opening, aligning seam with the middle point of neck opening back, overlapping edges for about 5 mm / $\frac{3}{4}$ " and sew tog.



Start from the bottom of cowl neck. Make 10 cm of seam with Mattress Stitch.



Turn collar inside out and finish seam. Picture shows RS.



Pin cowl on, overlapping neck opening edge for about 5 mm / $\frac{3}{4}$ ".



Cuff (make 2):

Foundation: loosely ch 12.

Row 1: ch 1, hdc in back ridge of 12 ch, turn.

Row 2 – 26: ch 1, hdc in front lps of 11 hdc from prev row, hdc in back ridge of turning ch-1 from prv row, turn counter-clockwise.

Fasten off, leaving 70 cm / 27 ½" end.

Thread tapestry needle with the end, sew last and 1st rows tog with Mattress stitch. Pin band to the edge of arm opening, aligning seam with sweater side, overlapping edges for about 5 mm / ¾" and sew tog.

Bottom band (slightly contracts sweater bottom):

Foundation: loosely ch 12.

Row 1: ch 1, hdc in back ridge of 12 ch, turn.

Row 2 – 105: ch 1, hdc in front lps of 11 hdc from prev row, hdc in back ridge of turning ch-1 from prv row, turn counter-clockwise.

Number of rows is approximate.

Do not fasten off after last row. Lock lp and start sewing band to the body. See if you need additional rows.

Sew 1st and last rows tog with Mattress stitch.

Finishing:

Weave in all rem ends.

Care:

Hand-wash in cool water, rinse in same temperature water, spin on high setting, dry flat on a thick towel.